Notes

1 This study owes its debts to many. First to mention the people connected to the Myanmar Update Conference at the Australian National University. Thanks in particular to the two editors of this volume – Nick Cheesman and Nicholas Farrelly – for bearing the brunt of my loose-knitted drafts. Apart from them I wish to thank Stewart Lone (my mentor, and former member of faculty at the UNSW Canberra), Delwar Hossain (University of Dhaka), and Tareq Mamun (Human Services, Australia) who offered early advice and encouragements. A note of gratitude finally to two anonymous reviewers for their invaluable suggestions of improvements – in some cases which led to total revisions.

2 In one such incident, on 30 May 2014, a Bangladeshi Border Guard was killed by a Myanmar patrol that crossed the border into Bangladesh (Al Jazeera 2014).

3 Dwelling in Myanmar, the Rohingya are sometimes said to be the world's most persecuted minority (Economist 2015). They are an ethnic Muslim group in this majority Buddhist country. Most of the Rohingya reside in the northwestern part of Rakhine State, formerly called Arakan State.

4 The NaSaKa has now been replaced by BSP (Border Security Police), though it is reported that many of the officers and staff have remained the same (Khan 2014).

5 However there has not been any easing of visa restrictions for the business people from either side, who still have to follow certain limitations of movement, especially when entering through the land border or the port at Teknaf.

6 My interview with Major General Shakil Ahmed, the then-Director General Bangladesh Rifles (now BGB) at Gundum, Cox's Bazar; Commanding Officer 42 Rifle Battalion and Detachment Commander DGFI at Teknaf, Cox's Bazar in November 2008.

7 Comment by Phil Loader, Executive Vice President of Global Exploration (ITE Group PLC 2015).

8 India has been developing the port in order to benefit its northeastern provinces (especially the state of Mizoram), which would ensure ocean access via the Kaladan River.

9 Historically, Sittwe has been a breeding ground for political monks in Myanmar: it was the birthplace of U Ottama, the first prominent monk to protest against the colonial British. In 2007 it was the monks of Sittwe who were among the first to participate in anti-government protests.

10 In one of these developments, on 25 August 2015, members of the Arakan Army infiltrated into Bangladesh and opened fire on a BGB patrol near the Bandarban borders that injured a BGB member; the gun battle lasted over six hours. In another incident, on 14 July 2015, BGB rescued two members of the Myanmar army who were abducted by a group of Arakan Army from near